Skyline Properties

Customer Support Knowledge Base

SAMPLE DOCUMENT FOR DEMO USE. The company, contact details and policies are fictional.

This document answers common customer questions on buying, renting, selling, investing, maintenance and complaints. Fees and rules shown are examples for training a support assistant and are not legal or financial advice.

1. About Skyline Properties

Q: Who is Skyline Properties?
A: Skyline Properties is a Dubai-based real estate brokerage founded in 2012. We help clients buy, sell, rent and invest in residential and commercial property across Dubai, Sharjah and Abu Dhabi. Our head office is in Business Bay, Dubai, and we have a branch in Deira.

Q: What are your office hours?
A: Our offices are open Monday to Friday from 9:00 AM to 6:00 PM and Saturday from 10:00 AM to 4:00 PM. We are closed on Sundays and UAE public holidays. The customer support line is available until 8:00 PM on weekdays.

Q: How can I contact customer support?
A: Call +971 4 555 0100, WhatsApp +971 50 555 0101, or email support@skylineproperties.example. Emails are answered within one business day. Urgent maintenance issues for tenants should be reported on the 24/7 maintenance hotline +971 4 555 0199.

Q: Is Skyline Properties licensed?
A: Yes. Skyline Properties is licensed by the Dubai Real Estate Regulatory Agency (RERA) and all of our agents hold valid RERA broker cards. Clients can ask any agent to show their broker card before signing anything.

2. Buying a Property

Q: What is the process of buying a property?
A: The buying process has six steps: (1) share your budget and preferences with an agent, (2) view shortlisted properties, (3) make an offer and agree on the price, (4) sign the Memorandum of Understanding (Form F) and pay a 10% deposit, (5) obtain a mortgage pre-approval or arrange the funds, and (6) transfer ownership at the Dubai Land Department (DLD) trustee office.

Q: What fees do I pay when buying?
A: Buyers pay a 4% DLD transfer fee on the purchase price plus a small administrative fee, a 2% agency commission to Skyline Properties on resale properties, and a trustee office fee. If you take a mortgage, there is also a bank arrangement fee, usually around 1% of the loan amount, and a property valuation fee.

Q: How much deposit is required?
A: A 10% deposit is paid when the Memorandum of Understanding is signed. It is held in escrow by the trustee office or the developer and is applied to the purchase price. For mortgage buyers, the bank usually finances up to 80% of the property value for UAE residents and up to 60% to 70% for non-residents on a first property.

Q: Can foreigners buy property in Dubai?
A: Yes. Foreign nationals can buy freehold property in designated freehold areas of Dubai such as Downtown Dubai, Dubai Marina, Palm Jumeirah, Business Bay and Jumeirah Village Circle. Non-resident buyers need a valid passport; no UAE residency is required to purchase.

Q: Do you offer off-plan properties and payment plans?
A: Yes. We sell off-plan properties directly from leading developers. Typical payment plans are 60/40 (60% during construction, 40% on handover) or 80/20, and some developers offer post-handover plans of up to 3 years. A booking deposit of 5% to 10% is required to reserve a unit. Payment plan terms differ by developer and project.

3. Renting a Property

Q: What is the process of renting a property?
A: To rent, choose a property, view it with our agent, and pay a refundable security deposit to reserve it. We then prepare the tenancy contract and register it on Ejari, the official Dubai rental registration system. You receive the keys after the contract is signed and the first payment is made.

Q: What documents do I need to rent?
A: Tenants need a copy of their passport, a valid UAE residence visa, a copy of their Emirates ID, and a post-dated cheque or online payment for the rent. Companies need a valid trade licence copy and the authorised signatory's passport and Emirates ID.

Q: How much is the security deposit?
A: The security deposit is 5% of the annual rent for unfurnished properties and 10% for furnished properties. It is refundable at the end of the tenancy after the landlord confirms there is no damage beyond normal wear and tear and all utility bills are cleared.

Q: What is your rental commission?
A: Skyline Properties charges tenants a one-time commission of 5% of the annual rent, with a minimum fee of AED 1,500. The Ejari registration fee of about AED 220 and the municipality housing fee are separate and paid by the tenant.

Q: Can I pay rent in instalments?
A: Yes. Most landlords accept 1, 2, 4 or 12 cheques, and some accept bank transfers. Fewer cheques often means a lower rent, so ask our agent to negotiate. Please note that landlord policies differ for each property.

Q: How do I renew or terminate my tenancy?
A: To renew, contact us at least 90 days before your contract expires. A landlord must give tenants 90 days written notice, through a notary public or registered mail, before increasing the rent or refusing to renew. Early termination may carry a penalty, usually up to two months of rent, depending on your contract.

4. Selling and Valuation

Q: How do I list my property for sale with Skyline?
A: Contact any agent to book a free property valuation visit. After valuation, you sign a seller agreement (Form A) and we list your property on major portals, our website and social media. Professional photography and a video tour are included at no extra cost.

Q: How long does it take to sell a property?
A: Well-priced ready properties in popular communities usually sell within 30 to 90 days. Overpriced properties or those needing repair can take longer. Your agent will review the market with you every two weeks and recommend price changes.

Q: What fees do sellers pay?
A: Sellers pay a 2% agency commission on the final sale price. If the property has a mortgage, the seller also pays the bank's early settlement fee, usually 1% of the outstanding loan balance, and obtains a liability letter and NOC from the bank.

Q: Is the valuation really free?
A: Yes. Our market valuation is free and has no obligation. A formal bank valuation report, needed for mortgages, is done by a certified valuer and costs between AED 2,500 and AED 3,500.

5. Investment and Golden Visa

Q: Can I get a UAE Golden Visa by buying property?
A: Investors who buy property worth at least AED 2 million may be eligible for a 10-year UAE Golden Visa. The property can be ready or off-plan with an approved developer, and mortgaged properties may qualify if conditions are met. Our team helps with the DLD documents and the application. Visa rules can change, so we confirm the current requirements before you buy.

Q: What rental returns can I expect?
A: Gross rental yields in Dubai typically range from 5% to 8% per year depending on the area and property type. Apartments in areas like Jumeirah Village Circle and International City often show higher yields, while premium communities like Palm Jumeirah show lower yields but stronger long-term value. Figures are indicative and not guaranteed.

Q: Do you manage properties for investors?
A: Yes. Our property management service covers tenant search, tenancy contract and Ejari registration, rent collection, maintenance coordination and annual renewals. The management fee is 5% of the annual rent collected. Owners receive a monthly statement and rent is transferred within 5 working days of collection.

6. Tenant Support and Maintenance

Q: How do I report a maintenance issue?
A: Report issues through the 24/7 maintenance hotline +971 4 555 0199 or by WhatsApp with photos. Emergencies such as water leaks, electrical faults and no air conditioning in summer are attended to within 4 hours. Routine repairs are scheduled within 3 working days.

Q: Who pays for maintenance, the landlord or the tenant?
A: Under UAE rental practice, the landlord covers major maintenance and structural repairs. The tenant pays for minor repairs, usually up to AED 500 per repair unless the contract says otherwise, and for any damage caused by misuse. Please check your own tenancy contract.

Q: What are the service charges and who pays them?
A: Service charges are annual fees to cover common areas, security and building maintenance. For rented properties these are paid by the landlord. For owner-occupied properties, the owner pays them directly to the master community or the owners association.

Q: How do I get my security deposit back?
A: At the end of the tenancy, give 30 days notice, clear the final DEWA bill and chiller or gas bills, and hand the property back in the same condition apart from normal wear. We inspect within 3 working days and the landlord returns the deposit within 14 days of a successful inspection.

7. Cancellations, Refunds and Complaints

Q: Can I cancel a booking and get a refund?
A: Booking deposits for off-plan units are governed by the developer's reservation form. In most cases the booking deposit is refundable within 7 days of paying if you cancel in writing and no sales agreement has been signed. After the sales agreement is signed, cancellation terms follow the developer's policy and DLD rules, and refunds may be partial.

Q: Are viewing appointments free?
A: Yes. Property viewings are free and without obligation. Please book at least 4 hours in advance so our agent can arrange access. Virtual video tours are available for overseas clients.

Q: How do I make a complaint?
A: Email complaints@skylineproperties.example with your name, contact number and property reference. We acknowledge complaints within 24 hours and aim to resolve them within 7 working days. If you are not satisfied, you can escalate the matter to RERA or the Rental Disputes Settlement Centre.

Q: Do you accept payments by card or cash?
A: We accept bank transfer, manager's cheque and credit or debit card at our office. Cash payments are not accepted for transactions above AED 55,000, in line with UAE anti-money-laundering rules. All payments are receipted.